

CRISTINA MONZER

CONTACT INFO

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ACADEMIC APPOINT- MENTS

POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW 2025 - current
Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania | Philadelphia, U.S.

Conduct research on political identity and AI on social media platforms
Perform computational visual analysis and webscraping TikTok data
Member of the Politics, Identities, and Communication Lab (PICL)

RESEARCHER 2023 - 2024
Department of Sociology and Political Science, Norwegian University of Science and Technology | Trondheim, Norway

Geo-referencing historical maps for Africa and Asia 1750-1920

VISITING RESEARCHER Apr - Jun 2022
Computational Communication Lab, University of Vienna | Vienna, Austria

Research stay hosted by Prof. Annie Waldherr

EDUCATION

PhD in Political Science 2019 - 2024
Norwegian University of Science and Technology | Trondheim, Norway

Defense date: September 13, 2024

Dissertation title: "Aligning and deviating voices: Toward a theory of cultural resonance in political communication"

Research Master's in Communication Science 2016 - 2018
University of Amsterdam | Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Specialization: Journalism Studies and Political Communication

BA in Sociology and Communication Science 2012 - 2016
Ludwig Maximilian University Munich | Munich, Germany

Specialization: Journalism Studies; Sociology of Gender and Religion; International Migration

AWARDS & GRANTS

Awards
2025: Best Abstract Award, ECREA Political Communication Section Conference, Innsbruck. "Political identity and visibility: Comparing self-presentation strategies across TikTok user categories"
2021: Mentee, ECREA Political Communication Mentoring Program for Young Scholars. Mentor: Prof. Annie Waldherr (University of Vienna)

Grants

2026: ASC Pilot Project, Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania (\$10,000). **Co-lead**. "Identifying biases in VLMs zero-shot classifications of race and gender" Lead: Silvia Téliz Martínez

2020: Strategic research funds, NTNU Department of Sociology and Political Science (€15,000). **Co-applicant**. "Cultural resonance of policy proposals in crisis and routine situations: A two-country comparative survey experiment." PI: Stefan Geiss

2020: Funding for research stay abroad, NTNU Faculty of Social and Educational Sciences (€4,000). **Principal applicant**

PUBLICATIONS**Peer-reviewed articles**

Jeon, G., C. Moy, S. Téliz Martínez, **C. Monzer**, N. Alayón, and D. Freelon (2027). *WhichTok? Comparing three data acquisition tools*. In: *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media*.

C. Monzer and D.V. Dimitrova (2025). *The role of value references in shaping cultures of engagement: evidence from Covid-19 news on Facebook in Romania and the UK*. In: *Human Communication Research* 51, pp. 40-51.

Freelon, D., **C. Monzer**, G. Jeon, C. Moy, and N.J. Williams (2025). *The post-API age of social media data access*. In: *The ANNALS of the American Academy of Political and Social Science*.

Bil-Jaruzelska, A. and **C. Monzer** (2022). *All about feelings? Emotional appeals as drivers of user engagement with Facebook posts*. In: *Politics & Governance* 10, pp. 172-184.

C. Monzer, J. Moeller, N. Helberger, and S. Eskens (2020). *User perspectives on the news personalisation process: Agency, trust and utility as building blocks*. In: *Digital Journalism* 8, pp. 1142-1162.

Book chapter

C. Monzer (n.d.). *Analyzing political AI-generated videos with computer vision and multimodal language models*. In: *Research Handbook on Visual Politics*. Ed. by D. Lilleker, A. Veneti, and F. Marquart. 2nd ed. in preparation. Edward Elgar Publishing. Chap. 25.

Working papers

C. Monzer, C. Baden, and S. Geiss (n.d.). *How culture works in frames: Conceptualizing cultural carries*. in preparation.

C. Monzer, S. Geiss, and T. Aalberg (n.d.). *Individual resonance, not cultural: How resonance impacts framing effects*. submitted.

C. Monzer and A.O. Larsson (n.d.). *Gendered body representation on political TikTok videos: A cross-national comparison of Norway and Romania*. in preparation.

C. Monzer, S. Téliz Martínez, Y. (Julian) Lei, C. Moy, and D. Freelon (n.d.). *The political reach of non-political accounts: A typology of political expression on TikTok*. submitted.

Geiss, S., **C. Monzer**, and T. Aalberg (n.d.). *Ceilings and thresholds: Agenda-setting effects of news coverage among individuals with high and low initial issue salience*. in preparation.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

2017 - 2018

Institute for Information Law, University of Amsterdam | Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Conducted focus groups with online news readers in Germany in the ERC project *PersonNews*, led by Prof. Natali Helberger; resulted in first-author publication

EDITORIAL ASSISTANT

2018

Dr. Sharron A. FitzGerald | Munich, Germany

Compiled index for the edited volume *Realising Justice for Sex Workers: An Agenda for Change*

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

2014 - 2016

Department of Communication Studies and Media Research, Ludwig Maximilians University Munich | Munich, Germany

Developed a dictionary for the digital-automated identification of conflict-relevant concepts in the EU FP7 project *INFOCORE*

TEACHING

JUNIOR LECTURER

Sep 2018 - Jan 2019

University of Amsterdam | Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Tutorials in pre-master's class *Introduction to Research Methodology*

Tutorials in bachelor's class *Methods of Communication Research and Statistics*

TEACHING ASSISTANT - MEDIA SOCIOLOGY

Jan-May 2020

Norwegian University of Science and Technology | Trondheim, Norway

Lectures on communicator-research topics

Seminars on conducting quantitative content analysis of media texts

STUDENT TEACHING ASSISTANT - STRATEGIES OF MEDIA USE

Apr-Jul 2014

Ludwig Maximilian University Munich | Munich, Germany

Seminar on conducting literature reviews and organization of fieldwork

Thesis examination

Apr 2021: Examiner for Anjani Wollan (NTNU), master's thesis: "Framing and communication: A study of culture-sensitive communication regarding climate change and energy policy"

Guest lectures

Apr 2025: "Measuring culture". Guest lecture in *Communication and the Quantification of Social Identity*, Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania

Jan 2023: "The role of media in public opinion formation". Guest lecture in *Political Behavior and Political Communication*, NTNU

SERVICE

Editorial

2025 - current: Associate Editor, *Central European Journal of Communication* (CEJC)

2023 - 2025: Social media editor, *Gender and Justice*; Outreach officer, LEX Research Network (Law, Gender & Sexuality)

Conference organization

Aug 2023: Organizer, ECREA Workshop in Political Communication, "Communicating through the noise: Science communication"

Oct 2022: Organizer, ECREA Early Career Scholars Workshop in Political Communication, "Advancing concepts and methods in Political Communication" (virtual). Co-organizers: Emilija Gagrčin, Melanie Magin, Agnieszka Stępińska & Jakob Ohme

Section representation

2022 - 2024: YECREA Representative, ECREA Political Communication Section

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

Reviewer *The ACM Web Conference 2026; Journalism & Mass Communication Quarterly; Information, Communication & Society; Central European Journal of Communication; Frontiers in Sociology;*

Invited talks

Apr 2026: "Aligned identities, curated politics: Mapping political expression on TikTok across the ideological spectrum." CIND, Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania

Mar 2026: "Messy data, big questions: Social science in the computational age." Department of Journalism and Mass Communication, American International University Bangladesh

Mar 2026: "The woman in the machine: Gendered AI imaginaries on TikTok." Temple HCI Lab, Temple University

Apr 2022: "Cultural resonance in framing processes: is a methodological assortment required for concept development?" Computational Communication Lab, University of Vienna

Conferences & summer schools

2026: ICA; ECREA; AoIR

2025: ICA Hackathon; ECREA; IJPP Conference; APSA Political Communication Preconference

2024: ECREA; Milan International Summer School for Political Communication and Conflict (University of Milan)

2023: ECREA Political Communication Interim Conference

2022: ECREA; ICA; EPSA; ECPR Joint Sessions (Moralizing Politics, virtual); IJPP Conference; Norwegian National Political Science Conference; ESSEX Summer School in Advanced NLP

2021: ICA; Trondheim Analytica Workshop (NTNU)

2020: ICA; DGPUK Conference (Munich); Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS Rutgers, virtual)

2019: ECREA Political Communication Interim Conference; PhD Summer School in Comparative Social Science – Big Data (Prof. Neal Caren, University of Oslo); PhD Summer School Women in Political Methodology (University of Zurich); Workshop on Automated Content Analysis (Dr. Christian Baden, EVPOC NTNU)

2018: ECREA; ICA

2016: ECREA

SKILLS

Programming Python, R, $\LaTeX$, Git, WordPress

Own software WikiMatch

Computational text analysis Open-source and proprietary LLMs for text classification tasks; NLP and feature extraction (spaCy, nltk); unsupervised machine learning (structural LDA, word embeddings, BERTopic); supervised machine learning (scikit-learn, TensorFlow)

Computational visual analysis Keyframe extraction with scene detection (PySceneDetect) and semantic similarity (CLIP); object identification (YOLO11); image classification, object recognition, person identification and movement tasks (CLIP, YOLO11)

Data infrastructure Webscraping (Pyktok, Apify), Data collection and storage on Linux servers and virtual machines; deploying analysis pipelines on remote servers

Statistics & visualization Multilevel modelling (lme4, glmmTMB); hurdle models; data visualization (ggplot2)

Qualitative methods Focus groups and interviews; qualitative text analysis including grounded theory and (linguistic) discourse analysis; ATLAS.ti

Languages	Romanian (mother tongue)
	English (fluent)
	German (fluent)
	Norwegian (basic)

MEMBERSHIPS

Memberships & organization	R-Ladies, Trondheim
	Founding member, PhD "Hype Club", NTNU
	Organizer, Qualitative Text Analysis Methods research group, NTNU
	Organizer, PhD paper feedback sessions, NTNU
	2018: Board member, Amsterdam Research Initiative (student organization, lectures and workshops on current topics in the field)

REFERENCES

Deen Freelon	Presidential Professor, Annenberg School for Communication University of Pennsylvania +1 215 746 6214 dfreelon@upenn.edu <i>Postdoctoral mentor; digital politics, identity, computational multimodal analysis, webscraping</i>
Stefan Geiss	Professor, Department of Sociology and Political Science Norwegian University of Science and Technology +47 73 59 17 74 stefan.geiss@ntnu.no <i>Main PhD supervisor; cultural resonance, framing, computational methods</i>
Toril Aalberg	Professor and Head of Department Department of Sociology and Political Science Norwegian University of Science and Technology +47 73 59 83 59 toril.aalberg@ntnu.no <i>PhD supervisor; survey experiments, comparative research, public opinion</i>
Christian Baden	Professor, Department of Communication and Journalism The Hebrew University of Jerusalem +972 58 557 4837 c.baden@mail.huji.ac.il <i>PhD supervisor; resonance, linguistics, computational methods</i>
Anders Olof Larsson	Professor Kristiania University of Applied Sciences +47 479 68 780 AndersOlof.Larsson@kristiania.no <i>Collaborator; gendered body representation in political TikTok videos (Norway and Romania)</i>